

TABLE OF THE CHIEF JUSTICES AND JUDGES OF THE COMMON PLEAS.

A. R.	A. D.	CHIEF JUSTICE.	JUSTICES OF THE COMMON PLEAS.				
1	1399, Sept. 20	William Thuring	William Rickhill	John Martham	William Hankford	William Brecheley.	John Cokayn, Ch. B. E.
6	1403, May 14	—	—	—	—	John Colepeper	—
7	1403, June 17	—	—	Robert Hill	—	—	—
9	1403, May 14	—	—	—	—	—	—
11	1403, Dec. 31	—	—	—	—	—	—

TABLE OF THE CHIEF BARONS AND BARONS OF THE EXCHEQUER.

A. R.	A. D.	CHIEF BARONS.	BARONS OF THE EXCHEQUER.			
1	1399, Sept. 30	John Cussy	Laurence de Allerthorpe	Thomas Ferriby	William Ford	John Staverdon.
2	1400, Nov. 15	John Cokayn	Thomas de Tuttlebury	—	—	—
3	1401, June 17	—	—	William Ernayn	—	—
4	1402, Jan.	—	—	Thomas Overton	—	—
8	1403, March 1	—	Roger Westwode	—	Henry Merston	—
9	1407, Nov. 8	—	—	Henry Somer	—	—
11	1410, June 19	—	—	Richard Banke	—	—

In the commissions to the judges to take assizes in the different counties, serjeants were frequently joined with them. The Year Books furnish us with the names of Hill, Frisby, Skrene, and Norton.

An entry among the ancient records of the city of Canterbury shows that in 1402 the sum of eight shillings was paid for the letters patent for the judges to deliver the gaol; and that 1*l.* 6*s.* 8*d.* was expended in an entertainment to them and their associates, and 1*l.* 3*s.* 4*d.* in gifts to them and their clerks.¹

ATTORNATI REGIS.

DUGDALE names the following as holding the office of attorney-general:—

- I. 1399. Sept. 30. William de Lodington, called serjeant 12 Hen. IV.,
and made a judge of the Common Pleas in
3 Henry V.
- III. 1401. Thomas Cowley, probably Coveley, who held the
office under Richard II.
- IX. 1407. July 13. Thomas Dereham; who was superseded by
Aug. 17. Roger Hunt. One of this name, probably his
son, was made a baron of the Exchequer in
17 Henry VI.
- XI. 1410. Thomas Tickhill.

It seems probable that there was an advocate for the king in each of the two courts of common law; as Lodington is stated to have been appointed for the Common Bench, and Cowley for the King's Bench; and the closeness of the dates of the two patents of Dereham and Hunt arises apparently from such an arrangement.

SERJEANTS.

THE serjeants whose appointments are mentioned in this reign are divided nearly equally into serjeants-at-law summoned by special writ, and king's serjeants by royal appoint-

¹ Hasted's Kent, xii. 615.

ment. The latter are distinguished in the following list by the addition of a K; and those who afterwards became judges are marked with a *.

I. 1399.	* William Gascoigne, K.,	William Hornby, K.
	* Robert Tirwhit, K.,	* Robert Hill, K.
III. 1401.	John Read,	William Frisby.
IV. 1402.	Thomas Tildeslegh, K.,	* John Colepeper, K.
IX. 1407.	* Richard Norton, K.	
X. 1408.	William Skrene, K.	
XII. 1410.	* John de Preston,	John Barton, jun.
	* William Lodington,	Walter Askham.
	* James Strangeways,	* John Martin.
	* William Cheyne,	William Wynard.

The appointment of William Skrene as king's serjeant was a selection between him and Roger Horton, offered to the king by the chancellor to supply the place of Robert Tirwhit made a judge of the King's Bench, and is notified in the king's letter in answer, dated May 9, 10 Henry IV.¹

It would appear that Walter Askham, summoned in 12 Henry IV. to take the degree of serjeant-at-law, had disobeyed the writ or got himself excused; inasmuch as in the demise of Serjeants' Inn six years afterwards, in 4 Henry V., he is distinctly described as "apprentesio legis."² Barton, Martin, and Wynard, as we shall see in the next reign, refused to obey the writ.

When the king required money for his emergencies the serjeants were not exempted from contributing. We find loans of 100*l.* from no less than ten in the fourth year of the reign.³

There is no evidence or appearance of the serjeants being yet established in an inn of their own. The now-called Serjeants' Inn in Chancery Lane, which at the beginning of this reign was the residence of John de Scarle, the chancellor,

¹ Rymer, viii. 584.

² Dugdale's Orig. 143.

³ Acts of Privy Council, i. 202.